

Jerry Burger

Novel: *The Shadows of 1915*

Events

News and Reviews

Videos and Podcasts

Short Stories

Nonfiction: *Returning Home*

Social Psychologist

About Jerry Burger

New: Fun Stuff



Jerry Burger

✉ info@jerrymburger.com

Jerry was born and raised in Fresno, California. He received his PhD in social psychology from the University of Missouri and was a professor of psychology at Wake Forest University and Santa Clara University, where he established a reputation as a leading researcher in his field.

Jerry also is a fiction writer. His short stories have appeared in the *Bellevue Literary Review*, *Harpur Palate*, the *Briar Cliff Review*, the *Potomac Review*, and *Karamu*, among other literary magazine. One of his stories, "The Last Laugh," was identified as a Distinguished Story in the 2004 Best American Mystery Stories. *The Shadows of 1915* is his first novel.

As a scholar, Jerry is recognized as an expert on the psychological processes underlying deplorable and inhumane acts like atrocities and genocide. His research in this area was featured in a 60-minute broadcast of ABC News' *Primetime* and in the Discovery Channel documentary, *How Evil Are You?* He has given many presentations on this topic, including an invited address before the Council of Europe in Strasbourg, France at the 2012 conference on

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"Living Memories of the Holocaust in
Contemporary Society."

Jerry and his wife, Marlene, live in northern
California.

February 17, 2023 at 7:00pm

FRESNO STATE UNIVERSITY

Armenian Studies Program and
The Armenian Museum of Fresno

University Business Center
Alice Peters Auditorium

Reading, In-Conversation Discussion, and Book Signing

<https://cah.fresnostate.edu/armenianstudies/documents/pdf/jerryburger.pdf>

April 20, 2022 at 4:00 PM

SANTA CLARA UNIVERSITY

Learning Commons, Saint Clare Room, 3rd Floor

Reading and In-Conversation Discussion

https://www.scu.edu/library/news/calendar/#!/view/event/event_id/299403

March 3, 2021 at 5:00pm

KEPLER’S BOOKSTORE LITERARY WEBINAR

“Home Movie by Jerry Burger”

Tickets available at

<https://www.keplers.org/upcoming-events-internal/https://www.eventbrite.com/e/literary-seminar-home-mov>

June 7, 2020

ALL THINGS ARMENIAN

Interview with Jerry Burger about The Shadows of 1915

Podcast of interview available at <https://www.multicultural1600am.com> (On-Air; All Things Armenian)

December 8, 2019, 1:00

ST. VARTAN ARMENIAN CHURCH, OAKLAND, CA

Reading and Discussion with the St. Vartan Cultural Committee

<http://www.stvartanoakland.org/organizations/culturalcommittee.htm>

October 24, 2019, 7:30

KEPLER’S BOOKS, MENLO PARK, CA

Reading from the *The Shadows of 1915* as Part of Kepler’s Story is the Thing

www.keplers.org/upcoming-events

August 6, 2019, 7:00

BOOKS INC., CAMPBELL, CA (PRUNEYARD CENTER)

Reading, In-Conversation Discussion and Book Signing

booksinc.net/event/jerry-m-burger-kimberly-ford-books-inc-campbell

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Armenian Mirror-Spectator

mirrorspectator.com/2019/06/06/jerry-m-burgers-new-novel-the-shadows-of-1915/

The Fresno Bee

www.fresnobee.com/living/article231908413.html

Santa Clara University's Illuminate

www.scu.edu/illuminate/thought-leaders/jerry-burger/the-scars-of-generational-trauma.html

LA Times/Glendale News-Press

www.latimes.com/socal/glendale-news-press/news/story/2019-08-13/jerry-burger-armenian-genocide-shadows-of-1915-novel

Panorama am

<https://www.panorama.am/en/news/2019/08/14/Shadows-of-1915-Armenian-Genocide/2153267>

Santa Clara Magazine

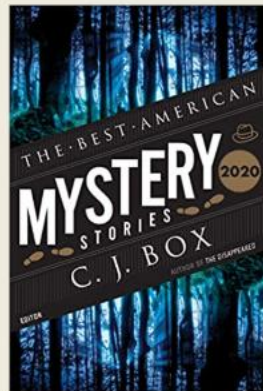
magazine.scu.edu/magazines/winter-2019/the-long-tail-of-genocide/

Hye Sharzhoom

Author Jerry Burger Speaks on His Novel-“The Shadows of 1915” – Hye Sharzhoom

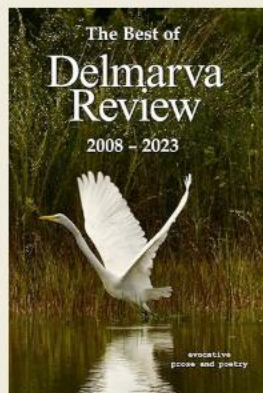
Short Stories

Jerry's short stories have appeared in the *Bellevue Literary Review*, *Harpur Palate*, the *Briar Cliff Review*, the *Potomac Review*, and *Karamu*, among other literary magazines. One of his stories, "The Last Laugh," was identified as a Distinguished Story in the 2004 Best American Mystery Stories.



Best American Mystery Stories 2020

Jerry's short story, "Home Movie," is included in Best American Mystery Stories 2020 (Houghton-Mifflin Harcourt). The story first appeared in the spring 2019 issue of the Briar Cliff Review.



Jerry's short story, "Booth," was one of 14 stories selected for The Best of the Delmarva Review, 2008-2023.

The anthology covers the first 16 years of the literary magazine. Jerry's story originally appeared in the December 2022 issue.

Recently Published Stories

"Transgressions" in *Harpur Palate*, Winter & Spring 2018, Vol 17, Number 2

"Home Movie" in the *Briar Cliff Review*, Spring 2019

"Booth" in the *Delmarva Review*, 2022

"Verdict" in *Pembroke Magazine*, 2026

Read Stories Now

[The Hand You're Dealt](#)
[Transgressions](#)



Social Psychologist

Jerry's research has made a significant contribution to the field of personality and social psychology. He has published more than 100 articles, chapters and books during his career. One analysis identified him as among the most prolific researchers in his field between 1980 and 1989, the first decade of his career. That investigation found that he was decade's fourth most published scholar in social psychology's most prestigious journals. Jerry's publications include a pair of books that summarize two programs of his research, *Desire for Control: Personality, Social, and Clinical Perspectives* (Plenum, 1992) and *Returning Home: Connecting with Our Childhoods* (Rowman-Littlefield, 2011). He also is the sole author of a best-selling college textbook, *Personality* (Sage, 2023), now in its eleventh edition.

Jerry's research has received a significant amount of recognition within academia. In January 2009, *American Psychologist* (the flagship journal of the American Psychological Association) took the unprecedented step of devoting an entire issue to his research on obedience and comments about his research. Jerry has been awarded Fellow status by the American Psychological Association and by the Society for Experimental Social Psychology.

Jerry's scholarship has also been widely recognized outside of academia. His research on obedience to authority was the subject of an hour-long broadcast on ABC News' *Primetime*. That research was the subject of a *New York Times* editorial, and newspaper articles about the work have been listed among the most widely read and most frequently forwarded stories of the year. His research also has been the subject of a Discovery Channel documentary, *How Evil Are You?* Jerry has given numerous presentations to academic and nonacademic groups, including an invited address before the Council of Europe in Strasbourg, France, at the 2012 conference on "Living Memories of the Holocaust in Contemporary Society."

After receiving a bachelor's degree in psychology and a master's degree in clinical psychology from California State University, Fresno, Jerry studied at the University of Missouri where he received his PhD in social psychology. From there, he was a professor of psychology at Wake Forest University and Santa Clara University.

[Social Psychology Network Page](#)

[Santa Clara University Faculty Page](#)